

Luca Alioto

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EDUCATION

Master of Urban and Regional Planning • Luskin School of Public Affairs

University of California, Los Angeles

Bachelor of Arts Political Science & Bachelor of Science Community Development

University of California, Davis

Completed PhD-level research methods sequence in Political Science

SKILLS

Quantitative Methods: Statistical Modeling, Causal Inference, Computational Text Analysis, Geospatial Analysis, Survey Design, Machine Learning
R, ArcGIS, JavaScript, Python, SQL, MATLAB, LaTeX, Quarto Git

Spanish Speaker - California Seal of Biliteracy, Upper Division Coursework, Study Abroad

EXPERIENCE

Researcher - Dr. Jamey Volker

Institute of Transportation Studies, Davis

June 2024– PRESENT

- Conducted empirical analysis on housing and transportation policy using R, Python, and ArcGIS for statistical and spatial modeling.
- Assembled and linked parcel-level, census, and food accessibility datasets to evaluate ~2,000 ADUs across the Sacramento region
- Designed and administered a survey to 335 permit recipients, using findings to analyze data that generated policy-relevant insights.
- Found that ADUs in the Sacramento region fail to meet city's affordability designation, challenging prevailing assumptions about ADUs as an affordable housing strategy.
- Authored a manuscript in preparation for submission to the *Journal of the American Planning Association* and presented research findings at the Association of Collegiate Schools of Planning (2025) Conference.

Policy Fellow and Leadership

Underground Scholars

September 2022 – PRESENT

- Researched and contributed to the Mandela Coalition (AB 280), a Youth Restitution Bill (AB 1186), and policy language around parole restrictions as a Policy Fellow through the UC Berkeley Underground Scholars Program.
- Secured \$5,000 in grants and coordinated multi-stakeholder events with UC Davis Law, the Aoki Center, and Yolo County Public Defenders to disseminate research and policy findings.
- Facilitated meetings between students and university administration to integrate student feedback into institutional planning and budget management for a new campus center now serving 100+ students.

Legislative Director - Campaign Coordinator

University of California, Student Association

September 2022 – 2025

- Conduct policy analysis and stakeholder outreach to advance the *Opportunity4All* campaign with Undocumented student groups.
- Led advocacy training and workshops for 30+ students, strengthening skills in public speaking and policy communication.
- Organized lobbying visits for ~50 students in Sacramento & DC.
- Developed and evaluated legislative proposals on environmental justice, housing, and land use in collaboration with Dr. Catherine Brinkley and local policymakers.

Volunteer Preparer and Translator

NorCal Resist, Sacramento

September 2022 – Present

- Provided bilingual (Spanish-English) assistance to asylum seekers in completing Form I-589, Application for Asylum and Withholding of Removal.
- Collaborated with supervising attorneys to review case materials and support accurate application submissions.

PROJECTS

Honors Thesis - Advisor Dr. Juan Telles

Political Science Department • September 2025 - Present

- Wrote an empirical thesis on backsliding in El Salvador with a potential for further publication and collaboration.
- Developed research design, conducted literature reviews, and applied quantitative methods to analyze institutional and social dynamics.

Research Assistant - Dr. Hanno Hilbig

Political Science Department • October 2024 - Present

- Conducted literature reviews and assisted in theory development for projects on political behavior.
- Cleaned and analyzed survey data in R, applying OLS regression and machine learning techniques.